> CYBERSECURITY DAY

CIPHER CHALLENGE

Crack the code. Learn the tip. Stay safe online.



01001100 01001111 01000011 01001011

// MISSION BRIEFING

How the challenge works

Teams of 3–5

Work together to decode each intercepted message.

5 + 1 rounds

Five cipher rounds that get harder, plus a bonus.

Beat the clock

3 minutes for easy rounds, 5 minutes for harder ones.

Score points

10 points per correct answer, +5 for the first team done.

Every decoded message is a real safety tip – remember them!

ROUND 01 // WARM-UP

The Caesar cipher

How it works

Every letter is shifted 3 places forward in the alphabet. A becomes D, B becomes E, and so on.

Hint

Shift each letter back 3 places to decode.

INTERCEPTED MESSAGE

VWDB VDIH

RQOLQH

A B C D E → D E F G H

3 MIN

10 PTS

ROUND 02 // LEVEL UP

The mystery shift

INTERCEPTED MESSAGE

SJAJW XMFWJ

DTZW

UFXXBTWI

5 MIN

10 PTS

How it works

Still a Caesar cipher – but this time the shift number is a secret.

Hint

The shift is between 1 and 10. Crack the short word first!

ROUND 03 // BY THE NUMBERS

The number cipher

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
N	**O**	**P**	**Q**	**R**	**S**	**T**	**U**	**V**	**W**	**X**	**Y**	**Z**
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

INTERCEPTED MESSAGE

12-15-3-11 /
25-15-21-18 /
19-3-18-5-5-14

Hint

Each number is a letter's position. A = 1. The slash (/) splits words.

3 MIN 10 PTS

ROUND 04 // MIRROR WORLD

The Atbash cipher

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
↕	↕	↕	↕	↕	↕	↕	↕	↕	↕	↕	↕	↕
Z	Y	X	W	V	U	T	S	R	Q	P	O	N

How it works

The alphabet is flipped: A swaps with Z, B with Y, C with X. One of the oldest ciphers in history!

INTERCEPTED MESSAGE

GSRMP YVULIV

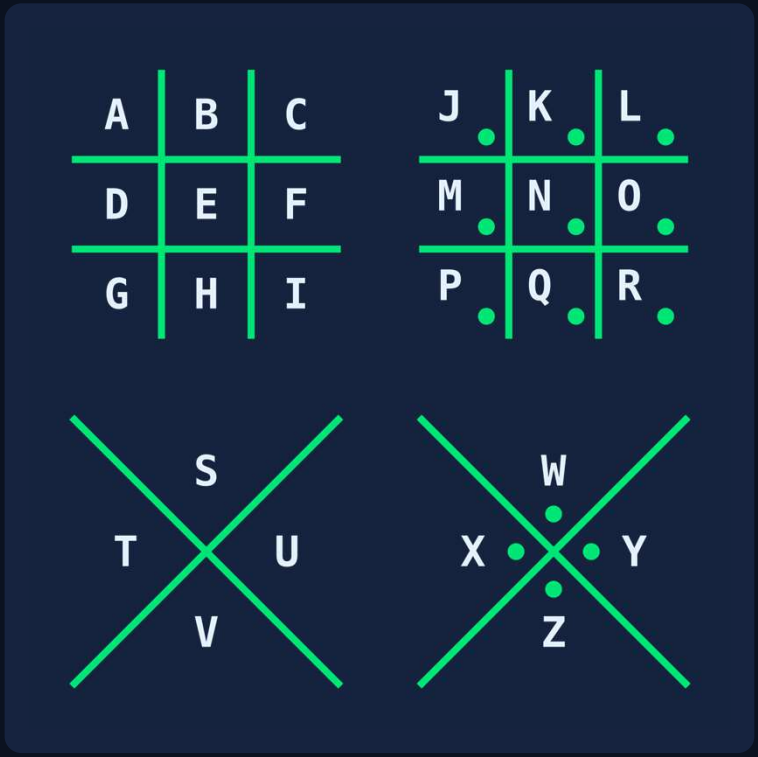
BLF XORXP

5 MIN

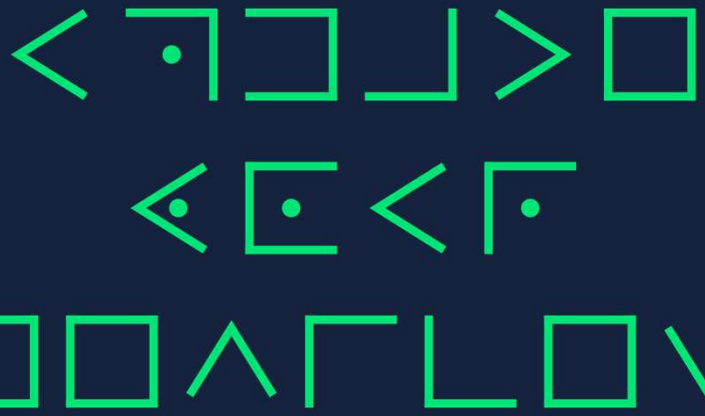
10 PTS

ROUND 05 // FINAL ROUND

The pigpen cipher



INTERCEPTED MESSAGE



Hint: Each symbol is the shape of the “pen” around a letter. A dot means the second grid or X.

5 MIN 10 PTS

BONUS // TIE-BREAKER

Reverse writing

SUDDEN-DEATH MESSAGE

DROWSSAP GNORTS

A ESU

Hint: Read it like a mirror – the whole message runs backwards.

1 MIN +5 PTS

// MESSAGES DECRYPTED

What you decoded

Round 1 · Caesar

STAY SAFE ONLINE

Round 2 · Mystery shift

NEVER SHARE YOUR PASSWORD

Round 3 · Numbers

LOCK YOUR SCREEN

Round 4 · Atbash

THINK BEFORE YOU CLICK

Round 5 · Pigpen

UPDATE YOUR DEVICES

Bonus · Reverse

USE A STRONG PASSWORD

// REALITY CHECK

Why real encryption is stronger

CAESAR CIPHER

25

possible keys. You cracked it by hand in minutes – a computer does it instantly.

AES-256 ENCRYPTION

2^{256}

possible keys – a 78-digit number. It protects your banking, shopping and messaging apps.

> ACCESS GRANTED

MISSION COMPLETE

Crack codes for fun. Lock your data for real.



Tally the scores and crown your champion codebreakers!